# Tree pit guide — shallow roots

Developer's guide for tree pits, shallow-rooted species · document TPG-S · 2026 edition (sample)

## 1. Scope

Applies to small trees and palms, e.g. Lagerstroemia indica, Livistona chinensis, planted on grade or on artificial ground (podium over a basement slab, roof).

## 2. Minimum dimensions

| Roots | Pit (min.) | Soil on artificial ground | Soil on grade | Drainage layer |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Shallow-rooted | 1.5 x 1.5 m (2.25 m²) | 0.7 m | 1.0 m | 100 mm |

## 3. Construction

- Drainage layer on the waterproofed slab, filter fabric, then planting soil to the depth above.
- Root ball top level with the finished soil surface; three timber stakes per tree.
- On artificial ground the greening standard counts a large tree in a pit of 1.5–4 m² as a small tree (Gi 1.0 instead of 1.5).

## 4. All guides

| Roots | Pit (min.) | Soil on artificial ground | Soil on grade | Drainage layer |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Shallow-rooted | 1.5 x 1.5 m (2.25 m²) | 0.7 m | 1.0 m | 100 mm |
| Medium | 2.0 x 2.0 m (4.0 m²) | 1.0 m | 1.2 m | 100 mm |
| Deep-rooted | 2.0 x 2.0 m (4.0 m²) | 1.5 m | 1.5 m | 150 mm |